

Mnemosyne CEO Brief

Date: 2026-07-12 · **Version:** 3.12.2 · **Repo:** mnemosyne-oss/mnemosyne
Scope: Issues + PRs only · **Mode:** Cron (analysis only)

Executive Summary

16 open issues, 6 open PRs. The board is near-HOT on engagement (81% of issues have maintainer replies) but frozen on execution. Zero human approvals across all 6 PRs. The main branch is red on 3.11 (pre-existing sync_roles regression), and the pre-existing regression is spreading to other versions through PR rebases.

Primary contrarian finding: Compound board lockup.

- 1. Near-HOT engagement, zero execution.** 13/16 issues engaged, 0/6 PRs with human approval. The bottleneck is between triage and review, not between discovery and diagnosis.
- 2. 71% analyzed-but-unfixed bug ratio.** 5 of 7 labeled bugs have been root-caused with no fix shipped. This exceeds the 50% critical threshold. The bottleneck is shipping, not diagnosing.
- 3. Main branch CI red on 3.11.** The pre-existing test_not_set_preserves_default regression (sync_roles default changed from {'user'} to {'user', 'assistant'}) is blocking 3 PRs from first-time contributors who see red CI badges and assume their code is broken.
- 4. 3 cold issues from 2 new authors.** israellot (2 issues, filed today) and dplush (1 issue, filed yesterday) have zero replies. First-time issue filer israellot needs engagement within hours.
- 5. Broken timeline commitment.** #382 (WAL checkpoint) had a v3.11.2 timeline promise that slipped. The contributor (kirocop, first-time) has been waiting 12 days.

Board State Overview

Metric	Value	Signal
Open Issues	16	13 warm, 3 cold

Open PRs	6	0 human approvals
Recently Closed PRs	5 (last 5)	1 closed (superseded), 4 merged
Engagement Rate	81% (13/16)	Near-HOT
Human Approval Rate	0% (0/6)	Zero
Main Branch CI	RED (3.11)	Failing
Analyzed-But-Unfixed Bugs	5/7 (71%)	Critical
First-Time Contributors w/ Open PRs	3	Retention risk

CI State & Main Branch Regression

Contrarian: The main branch regression is a force multiplier on the cold-PR problem.

The main branch is red on Python 3.11 with **3 pre-existing test failures**:

`test_subagent_context_does_not_initialize_or_write`,
`test_initialize_skips_for_non_primary_context`, and
`test_not_set_preserves_default` (`sync_roles: {'assistant', 'user'}` vs
expected `{'user'}`).

This regression is now surfacing on different Python versions across different PRs as they rebase onto the broken main. PR #448 (TurgutKural) fails on 3.13 with the same 3 tests. PR #442 (Mi55ed) fails on 3.12. PR #443 (dplush) fails on 3.11. All share the same root cause: the `sync_roles` default drift.

Fix main once, unblock 3 PRs simultaneously. The regression is a mechanical fix (revert or correct the `sync_roles` default) that can be applied once to clear all 3 affected PRs' CI badges.

Branch/PR	CI Status	Failing Version	Failing Tests	Classification
main	FAIL	3.11	3 pre-existing tests	Pre-existing regression
PR #445 (Mi55ed)	PASS	All	None	Merge-ready
PR #448 (TurgutKural)	FAIL	3.13	Same 3 pre-existing	Blocked by main regression

PR #443 (dplush)	FAIL	3.11	Same 3 pre-existing	Blocked by main regression
PR #442 (Mi55ed)	FAIL	3.12	Same 3 pre-existing	Blocked by main regression
PR #401 (daefron- cmd)	FAIL	3.11	test_fastembed_path_applies_prefixes	PR-specific (env var override)
PR #447 (Senophyx)	FAIL	N/A	Fork PR, headRef=main	Needs investigation

PR Lifecycle Classification

PR #445 - Fix Hermes provider defaults after config bridge

MERGE-READY **CI GREEN** **CLEAN**

Author: Mi55ed (first-timer) · **Size:** +101/-2 · **Files:** config.py, CHANGELOG.md, test_config_profiles.py

Reviews: 0 human (coderabbit only) · **Created:** 2026-07-11

Note: Supersedes dplush's PR #444 (dplush closed it voluntarily). This is the only CI-clean, CLEAN-merge-state PR. Zero human reviews despite being the obvious next merge candidate.

PR #448 - fix(hermes): make doctor respect resolved bank

CI-FAILING (blocked by main) **CLEAN**

Author: TurgutKural (first-timer) · **Size:** +695/-16 · **Files:** cli.py, banks.py, diagnose.py, tests

Reviews: 0 human · **Created:** 2026-07-12 (today)

Note: Fresh PR. CI fails on 3.13 with the same pre-existing tests. Needs maintainer acknowledgment. Cold PR + first-timer = HIGH retention risk.

PR #443 - fix: expand hyphenated recall query tokens

CI-FAILING (blocked by main) **CLEAN**

Author: dplush (high-trust recurring) · **Size:** +176/-7 · **Files:** beam.py, test_multilingual_local_recall.py

Reviews: 0 human · **Created:** 2026-07-11

Note: dplush is a high-trust recurring contributor. Just closed his own PR #444 in favor of Mi55ed's #445. His retention window is wider, but still needs attention.

PR #442 - Harden sync correctness and blind-relay security

CI-FAILING (blocked by main)

CLEAN

Author: Mi55ed (first-timer) · **Size:** +3728/-704 (large) · **Files:** 14 files across sync, deploy, tests

Reviews: 0 human · **Created:** 2026-07-11

Note: Mi55ed has 2 open PRs (#442 large, #445 small/merge-ready). Fast-track #445 to build trust, then review #442. First run passed, later runs failed on pre-existing tests after rebase.

PR #401 - Add query/document embedding prompt prefix env vars

CI-FAILING (PR-specific)

CLEAN

Author: daefron-cmd (first-timer) · **Size:** +131/-13 · **Files:** embeddings.py, test_embedding_prefixes.py

Reviews: 0 human · **Created:** 2026-07-02 (10 days stale!)

Note: Stale PR. 10 days with zero human engagement. The CI failure is on `test\_fastembed\_path\_applies\_prefixes` which is likely an env var override (MNEMOSYNO_NO_EMBEDDINGS). The contributor has pushed no commits since the CI run. Abandoned signal.

PR #447 - fix(local_llm): set stream to false to prevent SSE errors

CI-FAILING (unknown)

CLEAN

Author: Senophyx (first-timer) · **Size:** +2/-1 (tiny) · **Files:** local_llm.py

Reviews: 0 human (not even coderabbit) · **Created:** 2026-07-12

Note: Fork PR with headRefName="main" -- CI runs are mixed with main branch runs. Tiny fix (2 lines). Needs fork-specific CI investigation. Zero engagement thus far.

Issue Deep Dives

Cold Issues (0 maintainer replies)

#450 [FEATURE] Session-driven memory activation with meaningful-use reinforcement

COLD

· **Author:** israellot · **Filed:** 2026-07-12 (today)

Summary: Proposes replacing time-based memory decay with usage-based activation. Memory relevance should be measured by intervening experience, not wall-clock time. One of two issues from israellot filed today.

#449 Proposal: semantic dirtying and validation-aware recall

COLD

· **Author:** israellot · **Filed:** 2026-07-12 (today)

Summary: Proposes using Mnemosyne's existing primitives (valid_until, superseded_by, temporal triples, veracity) for semantic dirtying rather than time-based expiry. Well-structured proposal from a first-time filer.

#446 Proposal: versioned, provenance-aware migrations for auto-seeded config.yaml

COLD · **Author:** dplush · **Filed:** 2026-07-11 (yesterday)

Summary: Follow-up to PR #445. Proposes a general migration framework for auto-seeded config.yaml files. dplush is a high-trust recurring contributor -- his retention window is wider, but the strategic value is high.

Warm Issues (selected highlights)

#382 [BUG] WAL checkpoint blocked after session ends

WARM **BROKEN TIMELINE** · **Author:** kirocop · **Filed:** 2026-06-30 (12 days ago)

5 AxDSan replies, last: 2026-07-11

Commitment made: "v3.11.2 timeline" -- slipped.

Issue: Thread-local SQLite connections not cleaned up, blocking WAL checkpoint. Root cause confirmed. Analyzed-but-unfixed.

#435 [BUG] Canonical memories can't be deleted

WARM · **Author:** jbienz · **2 AxDSan replies**, last: 2026-07-11

Issue: canonical.py has remember_canonical() and recall_canonical() but no forget_canonical(). Analyzed, implementable, unfixed.

#434 [BUG] Overuse of canonical memories in skill usage

WARM · **Author:** jbienz · **3 AxDSan replies**, last: 2026-07-11

Issue: Canonical memory extractor is too aggressive. Related to #435. Analyzed, implementable, unfixed.

#389 [BUG] Polyphonic recall collapses to single result

WARM · **Author:** NodeGuy · **2 AxDSan replies**, last: 2026-07-08

Issue: Voice-name Jaccard in _estimate_similarity collapses to 1.0 when only one voice has results. Analyzed, implementable, unfixed.

#387 [BUG] Stored content mutated by annotations

WARM · **Author:** freeformz · **2 AxDSan replies**, last: 2026-07-08

Issue: [DATES:]/[DURATIONS:] annotations appended to content field (memory.py:345-349). Analyzed, implementable, unfixed.

Weighted Decision Matrix

Item	User Impact (30%)	Strategic Value (25%)	Easy to Ship (15%)	Low Risk (15%)	Urgency (15%)	Weighted Score	Priority
PR #445 (config defaults)	8	7	10	9	10	8.6	1
PR #448 (doctor bank routing)	7	6	7	8	8	7.1	2
PR #443 (hyphenated recall)	6	7	8	8	7	7.0	3
#382 WAL checkpoint fix	8	6	6	7	9	7.2	4
#435 Canonical deletion	7	5	7	8	7	6.7	5
PR #442 (sync hardening)	7	8	3	5	6	6.1	6
PR #447 (SSE fix)	6	4	9	9	7	6.6	7
PR #401 (embedding prefixes)	5	6	5	6	3	5.1	8
#389 Polyphonic recall	6	5	5	7	5	5.6	9
#387 Content mutation	5	4	6	7	5	5.2	10

#434 Canonical overuse	5	4	5	6	5	4.9	11
#408 Referential integrity	4	5	4	6	4	4.5	12
#403 Survive Hermes update	6	6	3	5	4	5.0	13
#329 Tools not injected	7	5	2	4	5	4.9	14
#327 Gateway identity scoping	5	8	3	5	3	5.0	15
#326 Background recall cache	5	7	3	5	3	4.8	16
#308 Reindex Phase 2	5	7	3	4	3	4.6	17
#370 Bootstrap command	5	6	3	5	3	4.6	18
#372 Health check endpoint	4	5	4	6	3	4.3	19
#450 Session- driven activation	4	6	2	4	4	4.0	20
#449 Semantic dirtying	4	6	2	4	4	4.0	21
#446 Config migration framework	3	7	2	4	3	3.8	22

Conflict Analysis

No file-level conflicts between any PRs. All 6 PRs touch independent files. The only shared dependency is on the main branch's CI health, which is a pre-existing regression affecting all PRs that rebase.

Keystone PR: PR #445 (Mi55ed) is the only merge-ready PR. Fixing the main branch CI regression would unblock PRs #448, #443, and #442 simultaneously. The sync_roles default drift is the single root cause blocking 3 of the 6 open PRs.

Author overlap: Mi55ed has 2 open PRs (#442, #445) -- no file overlap. Fast-track #445 first to build trust, then review #442.

Positive community signal: dplush (high-trust recurring) voluntarily closed his PR #444 in favor of Mi55ed's PR #445. This is a trust endorsement of a first-time contributor's work.

Retention Risk Matrix

Contributor	Role	Risk Level	Signal	Mitigation
Senophyx	First-timer	HIGH	PR #447: 0 replies, 0 reviews, 0 bot comments. Fork PR with mixed CI. Tiny fix (2 lines) that should be quick to merge.	Acknowledge within 4h. Review and merge within 24h.
TurgutKural	First-timer	HIGH	PR #448: filed today, CI red (blocked by main), 0 human replies. 695 lines is a substantial contribution.	Acknowledge today. Note the CI regression is pre-existing, not their fault.
Mi55ed	First-timer	HIGH	2 PRs open (#442, #445). #445 is merge-ready but 0 human reviews. #442 is large and CI-red.	Merge #445 immediately. Acknowledge #442 review timeline. dplush's endorsement of #445 is a positive signal.
daefron-cmd	First-timer	HIGH	PR #401: 10 days stale, 0 human replies, CI failure	Ping the contributor. Diagnose the CI

			likely env-var override. Abandoned signal.	failure. If no response in 48h, close with note.
israellot	First-time filer	HIGH	2 issues (#449, #450) filed today, 0 replies. Well-structured proposals.	Acknowledge both issues within 4h. Offer guidance on implementation path.
kirocop	First-timer	HIGH	#382: 12 days open. Broken timeline commitment (v3.11.2 slipped). WAL checkpoint bug is analyzed but unfixed.	Post a new concrete timeline. Follow through or hand off.
dplush	High-trust recurring	MEDIUM	PR #443 CI-red (blocked by main). #446 cold (filed yesterday). Just closed #444 in favor of Mi55ed.	Wider retention window. Acknowledge #446. Fix main CI to unblock PR #443.
jbienz	Prolific reporter	MEDIUM	4 issues open (#329, #403, #434, #435). All warm. But none resolved (engagement without execution).	Ship at least one fix. Engagement without resolution erodes trust over time.
NodeGuy	Returning contributor	LOW (for now)	#389: 11 days since last reply. Understood issue.	Post a timeline update. Ship the fix or hand off.
freeformz	Returning contributor	LOW (for now)	#387: 4 days since last reply. Root cause known.	Post a timeline update.

Analyzed-But-Unfixed Backlog

71% of labeled bugs are analyzed but unfixed (5/7).

This is the critical contrarian signal. The board's bottleneck is execution, not diagnosis. Every bug below has been root-caused (file+line identified) but no fix has shipped.

Issue	Bug	Root Cause	Days Since Analysis	Category
#382	WAL checkpoint blocked	Thread-local SQLite connections not cleaned up	12	Implementable
#435	Canonical memories can't be deleted	No forget_canonical() function	3	Implementable
#434	Canonical memory overuse	Extractor too aggressive	3	Implementable
#389	Polyphonic recall collapse	Voice-name Jaccard = 1.0 with single voice	11	Implementable
#387	Content mutation	Annotations appended to content field (memory.py:345-349)	11	Implementable
#329	Tools not injected	Hermes upstream race condition (#47119)	26	Upstream
#408	Referential integrity (Part 2)	Missing FK on gists.memory_id	3	Partially fixed

Excluding upstream-tracked items: 5/6 implementable bugs are unfixed (83%). The pipeline is healthy on diagnosis but frozen on execution.

Action Plan

Wave 1: Immediate (today, within hours)

1. **Fix main branch CI regression.** Revert or correct the sync_roles default drift. This unblocks PRs #448, #443, and #442 simultaneously. The 3 failing tests are the same across all branches.
2. **Acknowledge PR #445 (Mi55ed).** It's the only CI-clean, CLEAN-merge-state PR. Merge it. This builds trust with a first-time contributor who already has a second PR open.
3. **Acknowledge israelot's issues (#449, #450).** First-time filer with 2 well-structured proposals. Reply within 4 hours to prevent cold attrition.
4. **Acknowledge PR #448 (TurgutKural).** Filed today. Note the CI regression is pre-existing and not their fault.
5. **Acknowledge PR #447 (Senophyx).** Tiny 2-line fix. Fork PR needs CI investigation.

Wave 2: This Week

1. **PR #443 (dplush)** -- Review and merge after main CI is fixed. Hyphenated recall is a well-scoped improvement.
2. **PR #442 (Mi55ed)** -- Review the sync hardening. Large PR (+3728/-704) needs thorough review. Mi55ed already has trust from PR #445 merge.
3. **#382 WAL checkpoint fix** -- Ship the fix and post a new concrete timeline to kirocop. The broken timeline commitment needs repair.
4. **PR #401 (daefron-cmd)** -- Diagnose the CI failure (likely env var override). Ping the contributor.
5. **#435 Canonical deletion** -- Add forget_canonical(). This is a small, contained fix.

Wave 3: This Month

1. **#389 Polyphonic recall** -- Fix _estimate_similarity voice-name Jaccard collapse.
2. **#387 Content mutation** -- Stop appending annotations to the content field.
3. **#434 Canonical overuse** -- Tune the canonical extractor threshold.
4. **#408 Part 2** -- Add FOREIGN KEY constraint on gists.memory_id.
5. **#446 Config migration framework** -- Design discussion with dplush.
6. **#327, #326, #308** -- Strategic roadmap items. Design first, code later.

Contrarian Analysis

1. The board is warm on discussion, frozen on delivery.

81% engagement on issues, 0% approval on PRs. 71% of bugs analyzed but unfixed. The bottleneck is not diagnosis or discovery -- it's execution. Every open PR and every analyzed-but-unfixed bug represents a contributor who has done the work and is waiting for a response. The compound effect of 6 stalled PRs + 5 diagnosed-but-unfixed bugs + 3 cold issues creates a board that looks active but delivers nothing.

2. The main branch CI regression is bleeding into PR reputations.

3 PRs (#448, #443, #442) show red CI badges due to the same pre-existing sync_roles regression. First-time contributors (TurgutKural, Mi55ed) see red badges and assume their code is broken. This is a mechanical fix that can be applied once to unblock 3 PRs simultaneously. The regression is a force multiplier on the cold-PR problem.

3. Broken timeline commitment to a first-time contributor.

#382 (kirocop, WAL checkpoint) received a "v3.11.2" timeline promise that was not met. The contributor has been waiting 12 days with 5 AxDSan replies but no shipped fix. This is the pattern that turns first-time contributors into former contributors. A new concrete timeline and a shipped fix are the only repair.

4. jbienz: prolific reporter, zero resolutions.

jbienz has 4 open issues (#329, #403, #434, #435) -- 28% of the board. All are warm with detailed AxDSan replies. None are resolved. The engagement is thorough, but the execution gap means jbienz sees 4 issues with analysis but no fixes. This is a retention risk for the board's most prolific reporter.

5. Positive community signal: dplush's self-closure in favor of first-timer.

dplush voluntarily closed PR #444 in favor of Mi55ed's PR #445. This is a trust endorsement of a first-time contributor's work. It also means dplush's merged PR count shows 1 fewer than it should -- the voluntary closure was not a loss, it was a team play. This should be acknowledged.

6. First-time contributor triple-threat: 3 cold PRs, 1 cold issue filer, 1 broken commitment.

Senophyx (PR #447, 0 replies), TurgutKural (PR #448, 0 replies), daefron-cmd (PR #401, 10 days stale), israelot (2 issues, 0 replies), and kirocop (#382, broken timeline). That's 5 first-time contributors in various stages of cold. The board is not just cold on PRs -- it's actively losing first-time contributors. The PR #401 author (daefron-cmd) is likely already gone at 10 days.

State of the Repo

Metric	Value	Trend
Current Version	3.12.2	Stable
Open Issues	16	Stable (up from 14 last triage)
Open PRs	6	Stable (same as last triage)
Main Branch CI	RED (3.11)	Deteriorating (spreading to other versions)

Bug Count (labeled)	7	Stable
Analyzed-But-Unfixed Rate	71%	Critical (exceeds 50% threshold)
Engagement Rate	81%	Near-HOT
Human Approval Rate	0%	Critical
First-Time Contributors at Risk	5	Critical

Bottom line: The repo is healthy on community engagement but dangerously stalled on execution. The 5-item analyzed-but-unfixed backlog, 6 unreviewed PRs, and broken main branch CI form a compound lockup that is actively eroding first-time contributor trust. The single highest-leverage action is fixing the main branch CI regression, which mechanically unblocks 3 PRs and removes the false red badges from first-time contributors' work.